

I see 3-D

Nvidia has brought their GeForce 3D Vision kit to the Indian Shore. The kit contains a pair of wireless battery powered glasses and an infrared emitter. But remember you need a 120 Hz display for the 3D feature to work

Dual-core galore

New 45 nm dual-core AMD processors, codenamed Callisto soon to arrive. The processors to arrive are the Phenom II X2 550 and 545 as well as a Athlon X2 250.

Bazaar

MSI 770-C35

Red is in

With all the craze of new processors being released, MSI is one of the few to introduce a mid-ranged AMD board based on the AMD 770 and SB710 chipset and is named the MSI 770-C35.

This board has the length of an ATX form factor motherboard but is not as wide as a standard ATX board, which will cause a full length high-end graphics card to stick out even further than it would with a standard ATX form factor. The northbridge and southbridge heatsinks are dark red in colour. The southbridge heatsink is small and gets heated up quite a bit. Now MSI has done something really interesting, not only is this motherboard AM3 ready, but this motherboard also supports DDR3 memory. But at the same time, it was



equally strange to see a COM port at the I/O side of this motherboard.

When it comes to expansion, this motherboard has one PCIe x16 slot, two PCIe x1 slots and three PCI slots. The MSI 770-C35 comes with an interesting overclocking feature, which is controlled by two switches. According to the different positions you place the switches in, you can boost

the FSB by up to 20 per cent.

The DIMM slots are pretty close to the CPU socket, but even after we used a Cooler Master Hyper TX2, we could fit the a memory stick into the first slot, so it isn't much of a concern.

We used the AMD Phenom II 955 BE to test the performance of this motherboard along with 4 GB of DDR3 memory and an ASUS ENGTX285 TOP.

ASUS VK266H

26-inch wonder

If you thought your 22-inch LCD monitor was enough, think again, owning a 26-inch LCD for your PC is something to brag about and that's just what the VK266H from ASUS is all about.

The ASUS VK266H has good looks, the panel around the screen is glossy black, except for the silver line at the bottom that holds the buttons of this display towards the right. This display holds a whole bunch of connectivity options – VGA port, DVI port and even an HDMI out. This display also comes along with speakers and an integrated web cam. There is also audio connectivity through 6 ports for a home theatre setup or through 3.5-mm ports for PC connectivity.

We calibrated the display using Display Mate and Datacolor Syper3Elite calibration tool. The buttons were quite bad, more over there is no grip as such while constantly adjusting the brightness and contrast using the monitor's controls. When it comes to colours, this LCD



barely passed the 16 shade colour intensity shade, as all the primary colours just about made it through without merging of the last few colours.

The VK266H uses a TN panel and in conjunction with the large size (and therefore wider viewing angles) is not very suitable for multimedia content and definitely not for imaging professionals.

After the Spyder3Elite calibration, the difference in the before and after profiles were very visible, and we actually found the default colours to be on the cooler side, not reproducing reds, and to some extent even greens, properly. Also the contrast ratio was found to be 527:1 instead of 20,000:1; mentioned on the LCD.

This LCD display is great, though it needs some calibration, and if you are looking for a rig that you can comfortably watch full

Contact

MSI

Phone: +91-11-4175 8808 / 09

Email: marketing@msi-in.com

Web site: in.msi.com

Price: Rs. 4,800

Specifications

Hyper Transport Bus: Upto 5200MT/s

Chipset: AMD 770+SB710

Max memory: 16 GB

DDR3 support:

800/1066/1333/1600*(OC)

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	8
Build Quality	7
Value for money	7
Overall	7.5

We got some great scores in benchmarks such as 3D Mark 06 (16361), PC Mark 05 (11875), Cinebench (10465) and even with games such as Doom 3 and Prey.

DDR3 memory prices are already slowly on the decline. This motherboard would make for a decent upgrade and not a high end gaming rig.

HD movies on, then this is a definite recommendation from us.

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd

Phone: +91-22-6766 8800 / 1-

800-209 0365

Email: media_india@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.in

Price: Rs. 26,250

Specifications

Panel Size: 25.5 inch Wide

Screen, True Resolution:

1920x1200, Contrast Ratio

(Max.): 20000 :1 (ASCR),

Response Time: 2 ms (Gray-to-Gray)

RATINGS

Features	8.5
Performance	6.5
Build Quality	7.5
Value for money	7.5
Overall	8

released new Solid State Drives called the SSDNow V Series and are available in 64 GB and 128 GB capacities